

Footpool Tables

Soccer meets billiards: the bar game that packs the room.

What It Is

Footpool is a giant pool-table-shaped playing surface where players kick size-5 footballs into oversized pockets, playing by billiards rules. It is a physical attraction designed for sports bars, breweries, arcades, family entertainment centers, and event spaces. The core business is manufacturing or importing these tables and selling complete setups to venues, with the option to also operate a flagship location or a tournament league.

How It Makes Money

Two revenue lines. First, you sell or lease the tables to venues: a sports bar buys a setup the way it would buy a pool table or dartboard, because it keeps customers on-site longer spending on food and drinks. Second, you can run your own venue or "social" location charging per-game or hourly play, plus host paid leagues and tournaments. Buyers are bar and brewery owners, arcade and trampoline-park operators, universities, and corporate event companies.

Startup Costs

- Footpool table (frame, turf surface, pockets, walls): manufacture locally \$1,200-\$2,500 each, OR import from Alibaba at **\$450-\$900/unit** (FOB) + ~\$150-\$300 sea freight per unit
- Footballs, scoreboards, accessories per table: \$60-\$150 (Alibaba bulk)
- Sample/prototype unit for demos: \$800-\$1,500
- Branding, website, lead form (Coolify-hosted): \$500-\$1,500
- Trade-show booth or demo trailer: \$1,500-\$4,000
- LLC, insurance, liability coverage: \$1,000-\$2,500
- If running your own venue: space lease + fit-out \$8,000-\$30,000

Realistic launch budget (reseller model): \$6,000-\$12,000.

The Numbers

- Landed cost per imported table (unit + freight + accessories): **\$700-\$1,200**
- Sell price to a venue: **\$2,800-\$4,500** per table
- Profit per unit: **\$1,800-\$3,300**
- Sell 12-20 tables/month once distribution ramps -> **\$25,000-\$60,000/month gross profit**
- Own-venue path: a table earns \$15-\$25/game; a busy bar runs 20-40 games/day per table = \$300-\$1,000/day/table, paying back hardware in weeks.
- Realistic monthly net (reseller, months 4-12): **\$15,000-\$40,000** after freight, marketing, and overhead.

How To Start

1. Order one sample table from an Alibaba sporting-goods supplier and assemble it to verify quality and play feel.
2. Place it in a friendly local bar on a revenue-share trial and film a packed-house night of people playing.

3. Use that footage to build a simple sales site and a one-page "venue ROI" sheet showing extra dwell time and drink sales.
4. Lock in a container order (10-20 units) only after you have 3-5 verbal commitments, to keep cash safe.
5. Sell setups to bars with an install + first-tournament package to make it turnkey.
6. Launch a branded league (weekly tournaments) across your installed venues to drive repeat traffic and word of mouth.
7. Recruit regional reps on commission once you have a proven pitch.

Where To Get Customers

- Direct outreach to local sports bars, breweries, and pool halls (the visual sells itself)
- Instagram/TikTok reels of crowded tournament nights
- Bar and restaurant trade shows and hospitality expos
- Arcade/FEC operator Facebook groups and trade associations
- University student unions and corporate team-building planners
- Google Ads on "footpool table" and "bar entertainment ideas"

Pro Tips

- Lead with the ROI story, not the table. Owners buy "customers stay 40 minutes longer and buy two more rounds," not a piece of equipment.
- Be first in your country or region and trademark a league name. Owning the tournament brand creates a moat competitors can't easily copy.
- Offer a free 30-day in-bar trial with revenue share. Once the staff and regulars love it, the venue almost never gives it back, and you convert to a sale.